The Coronation (S4 Ep1: She-ra 2018)

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Summary

The day of Glimmer's coronation arrives, overshadowed by grief. Castaspella seems to be full of cheer, as she always is, though this time something's not right about it.

Is she not grieving? Or is this a cover for something else?
If today's happiness is insincere, what does this say about yesterday's emotions… and all the ones expressed before…

Notes

Hi! Welcome again!!
We're very pleased to bring you: Week 4's fic for the Thank You She-Ra event :D
This time, we shift the POV of *The Coronation* chapter, to let you see how our Castaspella carried the "death" of Angella and the "party" for her niece's coronation :3

I certainly hope you find it interesting, and while it took longer than expected to have this ready, it only means this is the best version we could cook XD

Ahem! Anyways!!
I hope you enjoy! See you at the end notes :D
~Xenakis

See the end of the work for more notes

When Micah and Angella got together, Castaspella started to spend time close to the Queen. Though, even with the proximity they suddenly had, she was not familiar with Castaspella the way her brother was.

She observed her like she would an outsider: she paid attention.

She did not yet love her but she *cared*; she wanted to know, to know about *her*.

Hence, the angelic queen took notice of the things other people were quick to dismiss: that emotionless look she had when she was distracted, the odd behaviour of the spiders she kept as “pets”… and this made her *cautious*.

Personality was one thing; Castaspella may have been odd, but around Micah and Angella she was making no effort to hide it, so it seemed like there wasn’t anything else to it.

Though as time passed, their energy and time was becoming more and more consumed by the war. That’s when the queen began noticing the disappearance of large groups of Horde soldiers, certain instances of battlegrounds covered with bloodstains but no corpses to accompany or explain them, or worse, places that looked overly clean to have been within a war zone.

No one would claim responsibility, and of course, no one would mention the gore; after all, better the enemy troops massacred than your own…

Angella thought no different; she had enough fighting the Horde, she wouldn’t fight people from her own side. So she kept this knowledge at the back of her head until the pieces came together, driving her to the only obvious conclusion.

However, Angella did not want to believe her capable of such… *violence*, even if it was for the right cause, *her* cause: protecting innocent people, her own family. She could have caught Castaspella literally red-handed, and *still* beg her to say it was all a misunderstanding because, despite it all, she was fond of the sorceress.

But, while she kept trying to feign ignorance to preserve their relationship, her resentment for Castaspella’s violence only grew.

With time, Angella lost awareness of her feelings on the subject, whether it was disdain for a cruel act or whether it was the disgust she felt towards herself for letting it happen, for *relying on it*…

Similarly, Castaspella had her own dilemmas: she'd wonder if her brother’s death proved the futility of her violence or the weakness caused by Angella’s strict moral code. Either way, it would only lead to more and more loss, until…

The news of Angella's death reached her quickly.

And with it, the explanation behind yesterday's unnatural events where not a single thing was broken and yet something was deeply *wrong*. Descent into a different reality… it had been stopped before it was too late.

It had been Angella's sacrifice.

Hence, just like she didn't want to reflect on what happened in the alternative reality, she didn't want to dwell on Angella's "death" either.

Her emotions froze but her reaction came just as fast as the letter.

Glimmer.

Her dear niece… She could imagine the pain she was going through.

She was aware that the loss of her father was a grave one…

But she was very little when he- She was not plagued with memories of his laughter, the way he smiled, the little tunes he'd hum… It must have been easier for her and so much more difficult in ways neither she nor Angella could ever have imagined.

As she grew up, she came to understand what happened to him, and listened to all the stories about him with utmost patience and stillness, absorbing every single word. She knew them by heart, made sure they didn't miss a detail… but…

The light words once said in a deep, hearty voice, were retold through the shaky breaths and dull tone of grieving women. What good was knowing, when it was never about the kind of song he sang, never about the punchline of his awful joke… It was how they couldn't help but dance along, how the laughter just bubbled up… How it all felt in the moment…

Glimmer *knew* about it but she hadn't ever *felt it*.

What a void he must be to her.

He was never there.

Angella *was*. Always and everywhere, and with her, Glimmer felt it all; the good and the bad, she was sure. No one could have possibly imagined she could ever be gone, being an immortal being and all…

This grief must be a cascade of emotions, entirely different from the previous emptiness, and she highly doubted that the two could ever cancel each other out.

Within herself, all this anger and sadness simply deepened an already existing wound. She had never stopped being a grieving woman really…

Today was just another day.

And so, instead of focusing on what was festering behind old bandages, Castaspella decided to focus on Glimmer.

The tightly strung smile barely left her face.

On the day of her niece's coronation, she was there as overly-cheerful as she always was.

Part of her knew that this wasn't what her niece needed, she should really tone it down. But at the same time, Castaspella had nothing else to give her. She knew she couldn't manage any sincerity without letting her emotions run free, she knew how cruel it all could make her.

It would expose a part of her she had never let Glimmer see.

Hence, she went ahead and planned the coronation ceremony with utmost excitement, hoping to at least remain familiar if not comforting. Instead of, possibly, making her feel betrayed upon learning her "Auntie" wasn't- Well, that she wasn't nearly as nice, and that it wasn't the only role she played.

After all, the sacrifices of a King and Queen won over the presence of a Mother and Father.

Better not remind her how that pretty halo was a chain of duty that could just as easily rip her away.

After all, there are many ways to die, aren't there? Loss, of any kind, remains *loss*. And the pain…

The pain must already be unbearable.

So she wouldn't let her lose anything else, *anyone* else. Not mentally, at least.

As the day progressed, Castaspella kept running around Bright Moon's Castle, giving orders, indications, and suggestions, sometimes getting Glimmer's opinion, even if just to have her participate in the organization of the event… And it was getting exhausting.

The sorceress felt her face muscles tire from the exaggerated expressions she kept pulling, part of her itched to just solve everything with sorcery…

Every time she felt herself returning to numbness after she had just spit out a bright reaction, she would jolt the other way, never letting the scales even out.

The firing of a plumerian florist in a supposed fit of anger, was later followed by a wave of self-pity: "I should just fire myself!"

Her rash and over the top actions just blended in with the all the surrounding chaos of the upcoming ceremony.

It worked well, no one contested or commented on her behaviour but, at this point, she was getting tired *of herself*.

Hence, this little break she decided to take on an empty room was… probably a wise idea.

Pressing her forehead against the door which she slammed shut just a bit too hard, she could finally let her mask fall. As her face relaxed, her mind dispersed a bit.

Constantly focusing on keeping up the charade was quite exhausting for her in many ways, especially psychologically, and made her feel oppressed, suffocated, like drowning in the sea of her own farce.

She only needed to give herself a moment, just enough for the ringing in her ears to subside, but not until she started thinking about what was waiting for her after the ceremony.

The moment her thoughts landed on an unfinished piece of work, some important document Angella had begun drafting but never got to sign off on… she left as quickly and abruptly as she had come.

What had just happened.

What's waiting for her.

Who she had just lost.

What responsibilities she gained.

The thoughts appeared and she shut them down, over and over again.

Back and forth.

Back and forth.

Just fast enough and she's almost in the present.

Returning to her duties, pretending she had just been looking for the ceremonial robes, Castaspella went to find her niece yet came across Bow and Adora. Fortunately, they believed her and simply helped her find the robes… which she had always known where to find in the first place. And then, they all went for the future Queen.

The robe was understandably ginormous, and seeing Glimmer's face the moment she realized how big a role she had to fill, Castaspella felt her heart shrink a bit.

Following her instinct, purposely this time, the sorceress approached her niece.

—Oh, my little Glimmer— she began. —I'm so proud of you— she told her, cupping her face. —I know you're going to make such a wonderful queen— she assured her, solemn. Glimmer's expression said enough. She didn't want to be a wonderful queen. She *didn't want to be a queen*. She didn't want to hear this, and Castaspella wasn't overjoyed having to say it either. But, what choice was there? She would act like she was, anyway. Back to her innocent

and cheerful mood, she said —Almost time for your quest! Give me a tick, and this robe will fit like a dream!

As soon as Glimmer finally handed Castaspella the robe, she disappeared somewhere, leaving the young soon-to-be-Queen alone.

Glimmer decided to head outside and… check on things.

And things seemed to be going…

Well, everything was a *mess*.

Everyone needed her help, everyone wanted something from her.

Decisions.

Advice.

Orders.

Duties…

It made Glimmer finally crack.

For the first time in her life she wanted to be *left out*.

This was all a party, just like all the ones she'd seen before: big people in bright dresses, colourful lights and sparkling glasses… all of it, and Glimmer was just a girl observing from the top of staircase. But, this time, she didn't want to join. For the first time, she actually wanted her mom to notice her and carry her back to bed, where she should have already been half an hour ago.

Taking the lantern, she requested only one thing: to get it over with.

This way, the ceremony was finally set to begin, and Castaspella surprised her niece having her robe refitted already.

The robe that was nowhere near her in the gardens…when did she even have time?

It fit perfectly, surprisingly enough, not like all those lumpy sweaters…

Suddenly, she missed their itch.

The Head Sorceress observed as her niece walked into the cave entrance along with Adora and Bow.

Now that Glimmer was out of sight, she could act just a bit more freely.

Taking charge in the most subtle way, she nudged the princesses to cooperate, work together, and finally organize the best coronation party they possibly could.

Without trying to force Glimmer to participate in decision-making now, it was far easier too. Each Princess was taking charge of what they had the skill to do, working more efficiently, fighting less…

It made Castaspella realize they had proceeded wrong before.

But she promised they would fix it all, and that was what they were doing now.

Eventually, her niece returned from the Chamber of Queens, fully charged by the Moonstone.

Glimmer, Queen of Bright Moon.

Castaspella never thought she'd ever see the day this would come to happen.

She never thought her brother's death would come so soon either…

But here they are.

Being welcome by a decent "party" that both celebrated her coronation, but also honored Angella's loss, the new Queen ascended to the throne and gave her speech.

The Head Sorceress was so proud…

Yet that awful feeling, which had began appearing more frequently in between the violent swings from sorrow and rage, whatever it was that she had tried to cover with excitement for the public, and mere apathy for herself, she couldn't ignore it anymore.

The party wasn't the best place to dwell on it, it was coming to an end but she couldn't leave. There was almost no chance Glimmer would want to see her tonight, but she had to stay just in case, just so she would know that someone else is close by.

That girl looked exhausted, she looked at guests with a face Castaspella recognised well.

It's no doubt that Glimmer will cry a lot tonight.

But will she?

Castaspella let out a sigh; just the thought of Angella had always brought a strange feeling to her, and now that all that was left of the queen was an already melting ice sculpture, her feelings became even more confusing.

End Notes

Well, that was it (/v\) ehe
I'm very excited for next week's fic, which may also take a bit longer to finish, idk, but I just love so much the concept we came up with for it that I've been looking forward to finishing and posting it since the beginning lol

XD In any case, heh, I hope you enjoyed, many thanks for reading, and see you next week!! :D
~Xenakis

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